

DESIGN & UX AUDIT — DISCOVERY PHASE

Ryan Legal, PC — ryanlegalpc.com

SUBJECT	PREPARED	METHOD
Public website, 5 routes, Next.js 15 / App Router	July 17, 2026	Live-site inspection at 1440×900, 1024×1366, 390×844 + repository review
SCOPE		
Audit only — no code changed, no redesign proposed		

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01 Executive verdict

The site is technically more careful than it looks and editorially less careful than its content deserves. Underneath a generic stock-photo-and-card-grid surface sits a genuinely well-engineered app — centralized content data, working structured data, a real dark-mode token system, a properly wired contact form with server-side email — attached to 35 years of unusually specific, verifiable proof (nine reported appellate decisions with citations, a 90% trial win rate, named FQHC and non-profit clients, AV Preeminent and Super Lawyer ratings). None of that proof reaches a visitor in the first screen of any page. The site currently presents

Russell Ryan's depth of experience with the same visual weight as boilerplate firm-description copy, which is the core problem a redesign needs to solve.

WHAT IT DOES WELL

Honest, uncluttered five-page sitemap with no dead links or orphaned content. Long-form biography and credentials are centralized as structured data (`app/content.tsx`) rather than hardcoded prose — a redesign can restyle without a content migration. Contact form has real inline validation and server-side email delivery. Alt-text discipline is consistent site-wide. A working prefers-color-scheme dark mode is already wired through a CSS custom-property token system. JSON-LD structured data is unusually thorough for a firm this size.

WHAT MOST LIMITS IT

Two compounding problems: a content-hierarchy problem (dense credentials and practice descriptions are rendered as flat, undifferentiated lists and single run-on paragraphs, so the firm's strongest material is the least scannable material on the site) and a generic visual system (unrelated stock photography across pages, one accent color used exactly once site-wide, and headings that — per a code-level defect, not a style choice — aren't even rendering in their intended typeface).

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Full-bleed photo hero + centered serif headline + icon-card grid was already a common legal-marketing-agency template pattern (FindLaw / Scorpion / Justia-style) by this point, and the site hasn't moved past it.

THE SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT CHALLENGE

Turn specific, differentiated proof (case citations, client names, hard numbers, decades of named training relationships) into an editorial hierarchy that reads as authority in seconds — without deleting depth to fake minimalism, and without burying it three tab-clicks deep to preserve "clean."

02 Scorecard

Scored 1–10. Not curved for effort or intent — reflects what a visitor actually experiences today.

AREA	SCORE	REASONING
Brand positioning	4	Target audiences (employers, health care, non-profits) are named clearly in the hero subtitle — genuinely good. But nothing photographic, typographic, or verbal is specific to <i>this</i> firm; the visual language is interchangeable with any small-firm template.
Trust & credibility	6	The underlying proof is unusually strong for a firm this size. It's just buried on /about , three tab-interactions deep, instead of surfaced where a skimming visitor will see it.
Information architecture	6	Five-page structure is sound and matches how legal buyers think. Loses points for Payment's total lack of on-site context and for About/Expertise sharing one interaction pattern despite serving two different jobs.
Content hierarchy	3	Weakest area on the site. Expertise topics are single undifferentiated paragraphs; About's Training tab is ~800 words of unbroken nested bullets; clients and ratings are flat lists organized chronologically/alphabetically rather than by relevance.
Readability	5	Body contrast and size are fine (16px, #505050-class gray on white). No character-width constraint on prose containers lets lines run wide on desktop, and dense paragraphs have no bolding or sub-heads to create scan points.
Visual design	4	Coherent but generic. A working color-token system exists but its one accent color appears

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AREA	SCORE	REASONING
		exactly once site-wide. Heading typography isn't even rendering as intended — a code defect (see §9), not a style opinion.
Responsive design	6	Mechanically solid — no overflow anywhere tested, forms and nav both adapt cleanly. But it's a single binary breakpoint, not a tuned multi-tier system, and About has a confirmed functional bug specifically on mobile.
Accessibility	5	Clears a higher bar than most small-firm sites (real labels, ARIA roles throughout, visible focus states) but every hand-built interactive component — mobile nav, tab system — has at least one confirmed defect.
Conversion & contact flow	6	The form itself is well-built and duplicated on Home + Contact so it's never far away. Loses points for zero privacy framing near an intake field and a single undifferentiated CTA label everywhere.
Existing-client utility	4	LawPay itself is legitimate and trustworthy once reached. The on-site /payment page gives zero reassurance or context before that hand-off, and holds full nav parity with persuasion-tier pages doing a very different job.
Overall experience	4	Real engineering care and excellent raw material, presented with a template-era visual vocabulary and a content-hierarchy problem that undersells 35 years of specific, differentiated experience.

03

Current user journeys

Prospective employer seeking employment counsel

HOME → EXPERTISE

Lands on / , sees the hero H2 name "Employers" explicitly — the strongest positioning moment on the site. Scrolls through three paragraphs naming FQHCs, Head Start Programs, and Community Action Agencies specifically — real relevance signal. Clicks the "Labor and Employment" practice card into /expertise?topic=labor-and-employment , gets one ~130-word paragraph naming five real agencies (CRD, EEOC, DOL, Labor Commissioner, EDD) but no representative matters, no outcomes, no invitation to go deeper.

Stalls here. Nothing on this page distinguishes it from a competitor's boilerplate practice blurb, and nothing links forward to the much stronger proof (90% trial win rate, named appellate wins) that exists two clicks away on About.

Health-care / non-profit organization evaluating the firm

HOME → ABOUT → CLIENTS

Best-served journey on the site. The hero explicitly names "Health Care Providers and Non-Profits," and body copy names FQHCs, Head Start, and Community Action Agencies by category — few competitors will have language this specific. If the visitor pushes through to About → Clients, they find ~19 named current health-center/non-profit clients (Altura Centers for Health, Camarena Health, Livingston Community Health, United Health Centers, Valley Health Team) — genuinely strong, sector-relevant social proof.

Succeeds, but works harder than it should. Clients is the last of 8 top-level About tabs, unlabeled as relevant to this audience, and presented as one flat alphabetized list mixed with farms and construction firms — the visitor has to scan past irrelevant peers to confirm their own sector is represented.

Another attorney considering Russ as local counsel

UNDERSERVED

This professional-referral audience is named explicitly in the brief but almost invisible in the live site. Bar/court admissions (9 courts, including the 9th/10th Circuits and U.S. Supreme Court) and nine reported appellate decisions with real citations — exactly what a referring attorney vets for — do exist on About, but with zero framing toward this specific reader. The line "he also assists out-of-town law firms as local counsel" exists in the underlying content data but was not confirmed rendering anywhere visible on the live pages inspected.

Largely stalls. A referring attorney has to already know to look for admissions and appellate credentials; the site never tells them "here's what to check," and the one sentence written directly for them may not currently be live.

Existing client trying to make a payment

PAYMENT → LAWPAY

Fast and functional if the visitor already knows "Payment" is a nav item — one click from anywhere, one more click to a legitimate, properly-secured LawPay checkout (visible lock icon, "256-bit encryption," "privacy protected" badges once there).

Succeeds functionally, stalls on confidence. Nothing on /payment itself explains what the payment is for, reassures the visitor the external redirect is expected, or gives a next step if the amount or process is unclear.

04 Page-by-page audit

Home

/

PURPOSE

Establish who the firm serves and why to trust them; funnel to a consultation.

WHAT WORKS

Hero H2 names all three target audiences immediately. Consultation form is embedded directly on-page. Practice-area grid gives a fast scope overview.

MOST SERIOUS PROBLEM

The page has no visual thesis — hero, firm description, practice grid, and consultation form all carry roughly equal weight, so nothing signals what to look at second. Compounding this: the accessibility tree shows **three H1 elements** on one page ("Ryan Legal, PC," "Our Practice Areas," "Request Consultation") — a real semantic defect, and the hero subtitle is rendered twice, verbatim, in the DOM.

CONTENT ISSUES

"For more than 35 years Russ Ryan and his legal team *has* provided..." — subject/verb disagreement. The "35 years" figure is hand-typed and already understates reality (~37 years as of 2026); it will keep drifting stale.

RESPONSIVE ISSUES

At tablet width (1024×1366) the Request Consultation section's background silently switches from a flat gray fill (at 1440×900) to a photographic image — an unintended

breakpoint inconsistency, confirmed via side-by-side screenshot comparison, not a deliberate design choice.

HIGHEST-LEVERAGE OPPORTUNITY

Replace the generic stock hero (a Yosemite waterfall with no connection to the firm, Fresno, or the practice) and the redundant repeated subtitle with something that does real positioning work in the first three seconds — a specific proof statement, or an authentic image of the attorney or office.

Expertise

/expertise

PURPOSE

Help a prospective client self-identify: "this firm handles my kind of problem."

WHAT WORKS

Clean two-column layout. Six practice areas map exactly to Home's taxonomy. Tab state is URL-addressable (?topic=) — genuinely good for a page whose whole job is being shared with a colleague.

MOST SERIOUS PROBLEM

Every topic is a single flat paragraph (40–130 words) with no representative matters, named clients, or outcomes — despite content that is inherently list-like (the Labor and Employment paragraph names five agencies and five dispute types inline in one run-on sentence). A visitor trying to self-qualify gets a summary with no evidence, and no path to the evidence that does exist elsewhere on the site.

CONTENT ISSUES

Specificity is inconsistent: only the Appellate Litigation paragraph names a real case citation (*Church v. Jamison*); the other five stay generic.

RESPONSIVE ISSUES

None significant — this page adapts cleanly at all three tested widths. The hero image (a stock "digital circuitry + gavel" graphic) is the one visual moment that breaks the site's own photographic language used everywhere else.

HIGHEST-LEVERAGE OPPORTUNITY

This is the natural home for "proof near claims." Each practice area should surface at least one concrete credential in the same view, and link forward into the relevant About content instead of dead-ending.

About Us

[/about](#)

PURPOSE

Build individual credibility for Russell K. Ryan — the actual asset being sold.

WHAT WORKS

Genuinely excellent raw material: AV Preeminent + Super Lawyer badges, nine reported appellate decisions with real citations, 150,000+ training participants, a 90% trial win rate, 29 named clients, bar admissions across two states and eight courts. Tab state is URL-addressable, same benefit as Expertise.

MOST SERIOUS PROBLEM — CONFIRMED FUNCTIONAL BUG, NOT A STYLE ISSUE

On mobile (390×844), the page loads with a topic already marked "selected" in the tab list, but the corresponding content panel does not exist anywhere in the DOM until the visitor taps a topic themselves — confirmed via zero accessibility-tree matches on load. Traced in `app/ui/about-carousel.tsx`: the `slide` state defaults to `false` while the content container renders `hidden={'{' }slide === false{' }'}`. Every first-time mobile visitor to the site's most credibility-dense page sees an apparently-broken, empty content area. Separately, at desktop and tablet, the default "Education" tab (2 short bullets) leaves roughly 900–1000px of dead gray space below it because the container is sized for the longest possible panel (Training) — the first impression of this page is mostly blank space.

CONTENT ISSUES

Two verbatim errors in the source data: "Judicial Clerks**skip**" (should read "Clerkship") under Positions, and a stray "(" fragment mid-sentence in the Training → Various Non-Profit bullet. The 24-current + 5-past Clients list mixes health centers, farms, and construction firms with no grouping, so a health-sector visitor scans past irrelevant peers.

RESPONSIVE ISSUES

Mobile tab-panel bug above; dead-space gap reproduces at 1024×1366 as well as 1440×900.

HIGHEST-LEVERAGE OPPORTUNITY

This page holds the firm's actual differentiators and currently asks the most work of a visitor (up to 11 tab interactions) to find them. Leading with 3–4 proof points every visitor sees unconditionally, then offering the full credential archive as real progressive disclosure, directly serves the goal of making 35 years of experience usable — not just present.

Contact Us

/contact-us

PURPOSE

Convert a visitor who has decided to reach out; provide practical means of contact.

WHAT WORKS

Dual contact paths (form + direct phone/email). The form is well-engineered: clear labels, specific inline validation copy, correct aria-invalid/aria-describedby wiring confirmed in the accessibility tree, no data loss on error. Live, correctly-pinned Google Maps embed with working directions.

MOST SERIOUS PROBLEM

No privacy or confidentiality disclaimer exists anywhere on the page or the site — confirmed via full-text search and sitemap review; there is no privacy-policy page at all. Visitors are invited to describe their legal matter in an open textarea before any attorney-client relationship exists, with zero expectation-setting about what happens to that information.

CONTENT ISSUES

The H1 ("Contact Us") and the first info card's H2 use identical text. No stated response-time expectation.

RESPONSIVE ISSUES

Minor only — the map bleeds slightly past the viewport edge at 1024×1366; cosmetic, not functional.

HIGHEST-LEVERAGE OPPORTUNITY

Add explicit expectation-setting copy near the form — what happens after submission, and a plain-language note that submitting it does not itself create an attorney-client relationship. The single highest-value, lowest-effort content fix on the entire site given what's being collected.

Payment

[/payment](#)**PURPOSE**

Let an existing client pay an invoice or retainer with minimal friction.

WHAT WORKS

The destination itself (LawPay) is legitimate, branded, and visibly secure once reached — lock icon, "256-bit encryption," "privacy protected," multiple payment methods including Affirm financing. The link is correctly labeled for screen readers.

MOST SERIOUS PROBLEM

The on-site page provides zero trust signaling or context before an external redirect to a third-party domain — no lock icon, no "you'll be redirected to our secure payment processor" language, no statement of what a payment covers. Meanwhile this is the emptiest page on the site (one icon, one line, one button) yet holds full top-level nav billing equal to Home, About, and Expertise — a proportional mismatch between content weight and navigational prominence.

CONTENT ISSUES

"Lawpay" (on-page) vs. correctly-cased "LawPay" (used in the site's own JSON-LD/metadata) — minor inconsistency.

RESPONSIVE ISSUES

700–750px of unused vertical space below the button at desktop and tablet widths — not broken, just visually unbalanced for how little content the page holds.

HIGHEST-LEVERAGE OPPORTUNITY

This is the strongest candidate on the site for a "utility action, not a destination page" treatment — see the Home/Contact/Payment verdict in §6.

05 Cross-site system findings

TYPOGRAPHY

The heading font-family variable referenced site-wide (`global.css`) is never defined anywhere in the codebase — every heading on every page silently falls back to the browser's default serif. A second typeface is loaded into the bundle but never referenced by any CSS. Body copy is hardcoded at a single non-scaling 16px !important across nearly every text element, which forecloses component-level responsive type scaling without fighting a global rule. Beyond hero H1 and one H2 size, the scale is narrow — too few steps between "headline" and "body paragraph" for a content-heavy site.

SPACING & LAYOUT

Page width is consistently capped at 1200px site-wide — a real, underappreciated strength. But no character-width constraint exists on prose containers, so paragraphs on About/Expertise can run close to the full column width on wide desktop viewports, past comfortable reading measure. The About/Expertise tab-container "sized to longest content" issue is the one structural layout defect that recurs across pages.

NAVIGATION

Identical top-nav and footer-nav link sets are functional but purely redundant — the footer doesn't add sitemap grouping or quick-contact info beyond duplicating the header. Current-page highlighting works correctly.

CONTENT STRUCTURE

The dominant pattern — vertical tab list + single content panel — is reused for two structurally different jobs (About's credentialing archive vs. Expertise's service-matching) without differentiating the interaction to fit either one. Efficient to build; produces one-size-fits-all presentation.

CALLS TO ACTION

"Contact Us" is the CTA label in essentially every context — hero, footer, mid-page banner — with no variation by funnel stage or intent. The one accent color in the design-token system appears in exactly one place site-wide: the footer CTA button.

TRUST SIGNALS

Real trust signals exist (ratings, named clients, appellate citations, LawPay's own security badges) but concentrate almost entirely on /about — absent from Home, Expertise, Contact, and Payment, the four pages a skimming, comparison-shopping visitor is most likely to actually read.

IMAGERY

Five different stock/generic photos across five pages share no consistent art direction, subject, or color grading, and none depict the firm, the attorney, the office, or the Central Valley specifically. The one real, specific asset — the attorney's own headshot — is confined to a single small circular crop on one page.

RESPONSIVE BEHAVIOR

Fundamentally solid — no horizontal overflow anywhere tested, clean stacking, working forms at every width. But the system has essentially one collapse point and treats 1024-wide "tall tablet" as full desktop, which happens to work here rather than being a deliberately tuned tablet experience.

ACCESSIBILITY

Clears a higher bar than a typical small-firm site — real labels, ARIA roles applied throughout nav and tabs, visible focus outlines. But every hand-built interactive component (mobile nav menu, tab system) carries at least one confirmed defect, consistent with custom accessible widgets that shipped without a final device-and-keyboard pass rather than a lack of effort.

06 Information-architecture assessment

Current sitemap

/ — Home

/expertise — six practice areas via ?topic=
/about — eight credential categories via ?topic=, plus ?expanded=
/contact-us
/payment — external hand-off to LawPay
/not-found — custom 404, no privacy policy or sitemap page exists

No orphaned pages, no dead links, clean reflection in `sitemap.xml`. The structure itself matches how a legal buyer actually thinks (who / what / how to reach), which is the right foundation.

Overlaps and misplaced content

Expertise's six practice-area names form a parallel taxonomy to About's implicit specialty grouping (Employment / Training / Health Care+Business+RE / Litigation) — related but not identical, and nothing cross-links them. Appellate case citations exist in two places with different completeness: Expertise names one case, About's Litigation sub-tab names six (including the same one) — a visitor who reads only Expertise sees a diluted version of a proof point that's stronger elsewhere. The "local counsel for out-of-town law firms" line — aimed directly at the referring-attorney audience named in this brief — exists in the underlying content data but was not confirmed rendering on the live About page inspected, meaning that differentiator may not currently be reaching its intended audience at all.

VERDICT — HOME, CONTACT, AND PAYMENT

Keep all three as separate pages; do not consolidate. Sparse is not the same as unnecessary — Contact and Payment are sparse because they're single-purpose utility actions, which is what a good utility page looks like. Padding them with content to "earn" a page would work against the one job each is meant to do. The real problem isn't page count: it's that all three are built on the same visual template as the content-heavy pages, which makes "sparse" read as "empty" instead of "efficient." Payment specifically is the one candidate worth rethinking in *weight*, not existence — consider whether a returning client is better served by a lightweight, reassurance-first surface (or a persistent utility affordance in the header/footer) than a full hero-image page-template holding equal top-level nav billing with the persuasion pages. Contact should stay exactly as full a page as it is now — the dual contact paths, map, and form are doing real work that condensing into Home would undercut.

VERDICT — ABOUT VS. EXPERTISE

The split is directionally correct and should be preserved, not merged. Expertise answers "does this firm do what I need" and should stay lean and scannable; About answers "should I trust this

specific person" and is justifiably the deepest page on the site. The current failure isn't the split — it's that both pages use an identical interaction pattern for two different reading behaviors, and neither cross-references the other. A visitor persuaded by Expertise's Health Care blurb is never pointed to About's Clients tab, where the actual FQHC client list lives.

07 Content-presentation diagnosis

Ranked by urgency — the content types where the gap between substance and legibility is widest.

1. **About → Training** (~800 words, seven nested organization bullets under one intro paragraph) — the highest word count on the site, buried three interactions deep (About → Professional Practice → Training), currently undifferentiated prose-in-bullets.
2. **About → Clients** (29 flat, unlabeled organizations) — the highest-value proof point for the named target audiences, structured for completeness rather than relevance; needs grouping by sector, not alphabetization.
3. **Expertise topic paragraphs** (six single-block paragraphs) — inherently list-like content trapped in run-on prose; the lowest-effort, highest-visibility fix, since this is the page most prospective clients will actually read.
4. **About → Ratings and Designations** (six items, each a 30–60 word sentence) — genuinely strong credentials rendered as dense prose-in-a-list rather than scannable badges with optional detail.
5. **About → Positions** (seven-item reverse-chronological list) — organized by chronology when a reader benefits more from relevance; gives no visual distinction between a 20-year tenure and a 1-year stint.

Recurring opportunity: a featured/pull-quote treatment for the single strongest proof point per section (a "90% win rate in 150+ trials" deserves to be a standalone statement, not sentence three of a paragraph); grouped client lists instead of one flat roll call; explicit cross-linking between Expertise's claims and About's proof, which currently don't reference each other at all; and genuine progressive disclosure on About — surface 3–4 top-line credentials unconditionally, put the full archive behind an explicit "see full record" affordance, rather than the current binary where everything is technically available and nothing is prioritized.

08 What should be preserved

Elements already working, that a redesign should build on rather than discard for the sake of change.

- ✓ The underlying content itself — specific, verifiable, differentiated (named cases with citations, named clients, real numbers). Genuinely rare for a firm this size; should not be diluted into generic marketing language.
-
- ✓ `app/content.tsx` as a single centralized data source — nearly all long-form copy is already componentized rather than hardcoded into JSX, so a redesign can focus on presentation without a content-migration project.
-
- ✓ The CSS custom-property token system, including a working `prefers-color-scheme` dark mode already wired end-to-end — a solid foundation to extend rather than replace.
-
- ✓ URL-addressable tab state (`?topic=`, via `nuqs`) on About and Expertise — shareable, bookmarkable, back-button-friendly, and should carry into any redesign of these components.
-
- ✓ The consultation form's engineering — real server-side email delivery, specific inline validation, correct ARIA wiring. This needs re-skinning, not rebuilding.
-
- ✓ The JSON-LD structured-data investment (`LegalService`, `WebSite`, `WebPage`, `BreadcrumbList`, `PayAction`) — already thorough and should be extended alongside the visual redesign, not treated as separate work.
-
- ✓ The clean, honest sitemap and the legitimate, properly-secured LawPay integration — the redesign opportunity there is entirely on-site framing, not the payment mechanism itself.

09 Prioritized findings

Critical 4 findings — actively harms comprehension, trust, accessibility, or task completion

1.1 **CRITICAL** /about — mobile 390×844

Tab-panel content is absent from the DOM on first load, despite a topic appearing selected.

Confirmed via zero accessibility-tree matches immediately after navigation; reproduced in `app/ui/about-carousel.tsx` — the `slide` state defaults to `false` while the content container is `hidden={'{'}slide === false{'}'}`. A first-time mobile visitor to the site's most credibility-dense page sees an empty content area under a "selected" tab.

1.2 **CRITICAL** `global.css:100` — site-wide

Every heading site-wide renders in the browser's fallback serif, not any deliberately chosen typeface.

`h1–h6` reference `var(--font-ibm-plex-serif)`, which is never defined anywhere in the codebase (confirmed by `grep` across `app/`). A second typeface (Charis SIL) is loaded via `next/font` but its CSS variable is never referenced by any stylesheet — bundle weight spent on a typeface that never renders.

1.3 **CRITICAL** /contact-us

No privacy or confidentiality disclaimer exists anywhere on the site.

Confirmed via full-text search for "confidential"/"privacy" (no matches) and sitemap review (no privacy-policy route exists at all). Visitors are invited to describe their legal matter in an open textarea before any attorney-client relationship exists, with no expectation-setting.

1.4 **CRITICAL** Navbar — all pages, mobile

The mobile menu doesn't close on Escape and doesn't trap keyboard focus.

Tabbing through the four open menu items in `app/ui/navbar.tsx` moves focus onto the underlying page content while the dropdown remains visually expanded and

marked `aria-expanded="true"`, confirmed via accessibility-tree inspection at each tab stop.

High leverage 6 findings – would substantially improve the experience

2.1 HIGH / – Home

Three H1 elements on a single page.

"Ryan Legal, PC," "Our Practice Areas," and "Request Consultation" are all rendered as H1 — confirmed via heading-outline extraction from the accessibility tree. Violates one-H1-per-page convention and flattens the page's actual hierarchy for screen readers and search engines.

2.2 HIGH /expertise – all six topic panels

Inherently list-like content is written as single run-on paragraphs.

The Labor and Employment paragraph names five agencies and five dispute types inline in one sentence. The page whose entire job is helping a visitor self-identify their problem currently offers the least scannable content on the site.

2.3 HIGH /about – desktop 1440×900 & tablet 1024×1366

The default tab view is mostly empty space.

The "Education" tab (2 short bullets) leaves roughly 900–1000px of empty gray section below it, because the tab container is sized to the longest possible panel (Training). Confirmed via full-page screenshot comparison at both widths — the first impression of the site's deepest page is mostly blank.

2.4 HIGH /payment

Zero on-site trust signaling before an external redirect.

No lock icon, no "you'll leave our site" language, no statement of what a payment covers — despite the destination itself (LawPay) being legitimately secure once reached.

2.5 HIGH Site-wide

One undifferentiated CTA label everywhere, one accent color used once.

"Contact Us" is the CTA copy in the hero, footer, and mid-page banner alike, with no variation by funnel stage. The gold/amber accent defined in the token system appears in exactly one place site-wide — an underused differentiation opportunity.

2.6 HIGH app/content.tsx — /about & /

Two verbatim content errors and one grammar error in source data.

"Judicial Clerks**skip**" (Positions) should read "Clerkship." A stray "(" fragment sits mid-sentence in the Training → Various Non-Profit bullet. Home's "his legal team *has* provided" is a subject/verb number disagreement.

Polish 6 findings — worthwhile but secondary

3.1 POLISH Navbar — desktop

A zero-size, hidden hamburger button remains in the desktop tab order.

Confirmed via computed-style/bounding-rect inspection at 1440×900 — a keyboard user tabbing through desktop nav lands on an invisible control between "Payment" and the page body.

3.2 POLISH /about, /expertise — tab components

Tab keyboard activation deviates from the standard ARIA Tabs pattern.

Arrow keys don't move directly between tabs; activation requires sequential Tab presses (up to 11 on About) plus Enter — functional, but slower than the conventional pattern.

3.3 POLISH /contact-us

Duplicate heading text.

The page H1 ("Contact Us") and the adjacent info card's H2 use identical text.

3.4 POLISH /payment

Brand-name capitalization inconsistency.

"Lawpay" in on-page copy vs. correctly-cased "LawPay" in the site's own JSON-LD/metadata.

3.5 POLISH Footer & /about

No freshness signals; one dated badge asset.

The footer copyright line carries no year at all. The AV Preeminent badge graphic visibly displays "2025" and will read as stale once newer badges are issued.

3.6 POLISH global.css — site-wide

Body copy is hardcoded at a single non-scaling size.

font-size: 16px !important is applied across div, p, li, label, input, textarea, button — forecloses component-level responsive type scaling without overriding a global rule. Worth resolving before a redesign builds new components against it.

10 Redesign principles

Specific to Ryan Legal, PC's actual material and audiences — not a visual concept, and not generic "luxury law firm" language.

01 Proof travels with the claim

Every service or practice-area description should carry at least one concrete, specific credential — a number, a named matter, a client category — in the same view, not three clicks away on a different page.

02 Progressive disclosure means "headline, then archive" — not "hide everything behind a tab"

Every credentialing section should have a default-visible summary of 3–4 items, plus an explicit, honestly-labeled path to the complete record. Never make a visitor guess that more exists.

03 Editorial hierarchy over uniform formatting

Not all 35 years of experience carries equal weight. The strongest, most differentiated material — named appellate wins, a 90% trial rate, FQHC-specific depth — should

visually outrank routine biographical facts, not share their font size and list style.

04 Warmth comes from specificity, not softness

This audience — employers, health systems, non-profits, referring attorneys — responds to precision and evidence, not casual tone or decorative friendliness. Approachability should be built through clarity and directness, not rounded corners or lighter copy.

05 One visual language, chosen on purpose

Replace the current mix of unrelated stock photography with imagery — or a considered alternative to photography — that's actually about this firm, this attorney, or this region. Consistency here is a trust signal as much as an aesthetic one.

06 Utility and persuasion are different jobs and should look different

Contact and Payment let someone who has already decided take one clear action quickly. Home, Expertise, and About build the case for deciding. The visual system should let a visitor feel that difference, not present all five pages as interchangeable peers.

07 Audience-relevant grouping beats chronological or alphabetical default

Client lists, training history, and affiliations should be organized by what's most relevant to whichever specific visitor is reading — a health system shouldn't have to scan past construction clients to confirm the firm knows their sector.

08 Every interactive pattern gets a real cross-device, keyboard-and-mouse pass before it ships

The custom tab and nav components on this site are ambitious and mostly well-built. Keep that ambition, but budget explicit verification time so defects like the mobile About-page bug don't reach production again.

Discovery and audit phase only — no code was modified in the preparation of this document. Findings are grounded in live-site inspection (Playwright, three viewports, all five public routes) and direct repository review (Next.js 15 / App Router, app/content.tsx, component-level CSS). Ready for the next phase: brainstorming visual and structural direction.

